arrangements. He personally joined volunteers in shramdaan, reviewed the preparations and inspired young participants to become part of this spiritual mission.

Alongside him, Respected Shefali Pandya also remained actively engaged in encouraging and motivating volunteers. On 23 November, the sacred "Shakti Kalash," consecrated by Dr. Pranav Pandya and Shaildidi, was ceremonially established at Bairagi Dweep. With this, the Akhand Jap (continuous spiritual chanting) began in the meditation hall, continuing every day from sunrise to sunset. At the same time, the tradition of the 9-kundiya Gayatri Yajna also commenced regularly at Shatabdi Nagar, filling the entire environment with profound spiritual energy.

A harmonious blend of tradition and technology

On 4 December 2025, the centenary year was formally inaugurated with the "Vasudha Vandan Ceremony." The event was attended by several saints, social leaders and administrative dignitaries. Among those present on the stage were Uttarakhand Governor Lieutenant General Gurmeet Singh (Retd.), Jagadguru Shankaracharya Swami Rajrajeshwarashram, and Dr. Chinmay Pandya. During the ceremony, sacred water and soil collected from 108 revered pilgrimage sites were worshipped.

This event was not merely a religious ritual but a symbolic expression of the Indian philosophy that views the entire world as one family—"Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam." As part of the centenary celebrations, a grand "Sajal Shraddha–Prakhar Pragya" worship ceremony was organised on 16 December. The programme symbolised the harmonious balance between faith and wisdom. In India's spiritual tradition, faith is regarded as the foundation of inner growth, while wisdom serves as the guiding light of life. The confluence of these two principles is considered essential for ushering in transformative change in society. The new year also began with this same spiritual fervour. On 2 January 2026, the "Rishi Kshetra" was formally unveiled. Dedicated to the memory and inspiration of the great sages who enriched Indian civilisation through their penance, knowledge and spiritual practices, the site stands as a tribute to India's timeless heritage. The inauguration ceremony was attended by former Union Minister of State for Defence and Member of Parliament Ajay Bhatt, Uttarakhand Chief Secretary Anand Vardhan, and Milind Parande, International General Secretary of the Vishwa Hindu Parishad. Subsequently, on 7 January, an advanced electronic media department equipped with modern technology was inaugurated. This initiative symbolises Shantikunj's effort to maintain a meaningful balance between tradition and modernity while disseminating spiritual messages to a wider audience through contemporary technological platforms. Speaking on the occasion, Dr. Chinmay Pandya emphasised that in today's era it is essential to communicate spiritual messages through modern technology so that they reach a broader section of society. He noted that the philosophy of the Gayatri Parivar should not remain confined to books alone but must also reach the youth through digital platforms.

The path toward a transformative era

The centenary celebrations formally commenced on 18 January with a flag-veneration ceremony. As the centenary flag was unfurled amid the resonant conch calls of the matri-shakti (women volunteers), a remarkable surge of spiritual energy filled the atmosphere. The flag was not merely a symbol; it was a proclamation of the resolve for yug parivartan—an era of transformation that the Gayatri Parivar has been advancing for decades. Present on the occasion were Uttarakhand Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami, Union Minister for Jal Shakti Gajendra Singh Shekhawat, Dr. Chinmay Pandya, and the head of Gayatri Parivar, Dr. Pranav Pandya. During the ceremony, Shaildidi described the dedication and discipline of volunteers as the foundation stone of transformative change. She emphasised that selfless service is the sustaining strength behind every enduring movement. Dr. Chinmay Pandya, meanwhile, called upon every volunteer to actively carry forward the vision of the Yug Nirman Yojana, encouraging them to become torchbearers of this mission. On 19 January, the seventh convocation ceremony of Dev Sanskriti Vishwavidyalaya was held. The event was attended by several distinguished guests, including Swami



Dr. Chinmay Pandya advancing the convergence of AI and ethics

As Artificial Intelligence (AI) expands rapidly across the world, the debate over making technology more responsible, humane, and ethically aligned is gaining increasing momentum. In this evolving discourse, Dr. Chinmay Pandya, an academic associated with Dev Sanskriti Vishwavidyalaya, Haridwar, is working to link AI not merely with technological advancement but also with ethical values and democratic governance. As Chairperson of SAIPR and Dev

Sanskriti Vishwavidyalaya, his focus is on integrating AI with India's knowledge traditions and promoting its constructive use in education, research, and governance. With this vision, Dev Sanskriti Vishwavidyalaya and the All World Gayatri Parivar jointly organised an important seminar on 20 February at Bharat Mandapam, Pragati Maidan, New Delhi, titled "AI for Democracy: Reimagining Governance in the Age of Intelligence."

The objective of the programme was to present AI as a tool that can make democratic governance more efficient, transparent, and accountable. The seminar brought together several distinguished international speakers, including Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla, Inter-Parliamentary Union Secretary General Martin Chungong, Deputy Speaker of the Hungarian Parliament Lajos Oláh, UK Minister for Artificial Intelligence Kanishka Narayan, Chairperson of the Royal Foundation for Peace Dr. Leena Becker, and Jaan Tallinn, co-founder of the Future of Life Institute, who shared their perspectives on the evolving relationship between AI and democracy.

Dr. Chinmay Pandya has consistently emphasised the importance of maintaining a balanced bridge between technology and spirituality. At a programme organised by the AI Faith and Civil Society Commission in Abu Dhabi, he highlighted that the Indian philosophical principle of "Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam" (the world as one family) offers a strong ethical foundation for the responsible development of AI.

In the same spirit, an international conference titled "Faith and Future: Integrating AI with Spirituality," held at Dev Sanskriti Vishwavidyalaya in Haridwar, further underscored that the future of AI must be guided by ethics, empathy, and human values.